

Paper 2: Early Elizabethan England, 1558–88

"What was life like during the Elizabethan Golden Age?"

**MASTERY PACK: KEY TOPIC 3: ELIZABETHAN SOCIETY IN
THE AGE OF EXPLORATION, 1558–88**

Operative / Student Name: _____

Target: Total Recall of 120 Crucial Questions

RESTRICTED ACCESS - MASTER YOUR MEMORY

How to Hack Your Memory

(Rules of Engagement)

1. Never Just Read

Reading the answers feels like learning, but it's an illusion. You must force your brain to struggle to find the answer. The struggle is what builds memory pathways.

2. Cover, Recall, Check

Cover the answer sheet. Write your answer down in the notes section (or say it out loud). Only then are you allowed to check 'The Vault'.

3. Track Your Threat Level

Use the R-A-G (Red, Amber, Green) checkboxes next to every question after you attempt it.

- ☐ **Green:** I nailed it instantly.
- ☐ **Amber:** I got it, but I had to think hard.
- ☐ **Red:** My mind went blank. (Revisit these tomorrow).

4. The Interrogation (Homework Protocol)

True mastery requires testing under pressure. Hand 'The Vault' (answers) to your parent or guardian. They will test you on 20 random questions. They hold the score; they hold the signature.

KT3.1: Education and leisure

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
1	What intellectual movement acted as a catalyst for educational reform in Elizabethan England?	☐	☐	☐	
2	Which prominent Humanist scholar was Queen Elizabeth's personal tutor?	☐	☐	☐	
3	What invention significantly helped increase literacy by making books cheaper?	☐	☐	☐	
4	What type of local school provided basic education for young boys and some girls?	☐	☐	☐	
5	What wooden object covered in a transparent layer was used to teach children the alphabet?	☐	☐	☐	
6	What type of school did the sons of the gentry and merchants attend from age seven?	☐	☐	☐	
7	Which language dominated the curriculum of the Elizabethan Grammar school?	☐	☐	☐	
8	Roughly what percentage of men, and what percentage of women, were literate by 1603?	☐	☐	☐	
9	Name one exclusive sport played only by the nobility.	☐	☐	☐	
10	What violently aggressive sport was played by the lower classes between neighbouring villages?	☐	☐	☐	
11	Give two examples of 'cruel sports' popular in Elizabethan England.	☐	☐	☐	
12	What was the Queen's personal attitude towards bear-baiting?	☐	☐	☐	
13	What type of plays did Elizabeth ban in the 1570s to avoid	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
	religious conflict?				
14	Name one famous pioneering Elizabethan playwright other than Shakespeare.	☐	☐	☐	
15	In what year was the first purpose-built theatre (The Theatre) constructed?	☐	☐	☐	
16	What was the nickname given to the poorest theatre-goers who stood in the open-air pit?	☐	☐	☐	
17	Which religious group furiously opposed the theatre, believing it was the work of the devil?	☐	☐	☐	
18	What 1572 law meant actors could be whipped if they didn't have a noble license?	☐	☐	☐	
19	Name one famous acting company sponsored by powerful nobility to protect them from the law.	☐	☐	☐	
20	Why did the location of the theatres (outside the City walls) exacerbate opposition from authorities?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): _____

Date: _____

KT3.1: Education and leisure

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
21	Who led the Spanish Armada?	☐	☐	☐	
22	What was the Armada's plan?	☐	☐	☐	
23	What tactic did the English use to break the Spanish defensive formation at Calais?	☐	☐	☐	
24	What was the decisive sea battle of the Armada called?	☐	☐	☐	
25	What role did the weather play in defeating the Armada?	☐	☐	☐	
26	What did Drake do in Cadiz in 1587?	☐	☐	☐	
27	When was Mary, Queen of Scots executed?	☐	☐	☐	
28	What was the Treaty of Nonsuch?	☐	☐	☐	
29	Who was Francis Walsingham?	☐	☐	☐	
30	What was the Book of Common Prayer?	☐	☐	☐	
31	What happened to the population of England between 1551 and 1601?	☐	☐	☐	
32	What economic problem was caused by demand for food outstripping supply?	☐	☐	☐	
33	What agricultural practice involved landlords fencing off common fields?	☐	☐	☐	
34	Why did landlords prefer breeding sheep over traditional crop farming?	☐	☐	☐	
35	What happened to unemployed rural workers after they were evicted due to enclosure?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
36	Which major European port city placed a trade embargo on English cloth, causing mass unemployment?	☐	☐	☐	
37	What term was used to describe the 'deserving' poor (the sick, elderly, and orphans)?	☐	☐	☐	
38	What term was used to describe the 'undeserving' poor who were physically capable of working?	☐	☐	☐	
39	What was the name given to a homeless, unemployed person who wandered from town to town?	☐	☐	☐	
40	Give two reasons why the authorities were terrified of vagabonds.	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

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KT3.2: The Problem of Poverty

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
41	Who wrote a famous pamphlet warning the public about the tricks used by vagabonds?	☐	☐	☐	
42	What was a 'Counterfeit Crank'?	☐	☐	☐	
43	What physical punishment was dictated by the 1572 Vagabonds Act for a first-time offence?	☐	☐	☐	
44	Under the 1572 Act, what was the punishment for being caught as a vagabond a third time?	☐	☐	☐	
45	What highly significant financial system did the 1572 Act introduce to help the impotent poor?	☐	☐	☐	
46	Who was responsible for collecting the Poor Rate in local areas?	☐	☐	☐	
47	What major economic reality did the 1576 Poor Relief Act finally recognise?	☐	☐	☐	
48	What did the 1576 Act order JPs to provide for the genuinely unemployed?	☐	☐	☐	
49	What institutions were created under the 1576 Act to punish those who refused to work?	☐	☐	☐	
50	Why did the government ultimately transition from brutal punishment to national poor relief?	☐	☐	☐	
51	Name two types of schools in Elizabethan England.	☐	☐	☐	
52	What was a typical subject studied at Grammar school?	☐	☐	☐	
53	What was a popular cruel animal sport during this period?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
54	Name one famous Elizabethan theatre.	☐	☐	☐	
55	Were women allowed to act on the Elizabethan stage?	☐	☐	☐	
56	Who led the Spanish Armada?	☐	☐	☐	
57	What was the Battle of Gravelines?	☐	☐	☐	
58	What phrase did Drake use to describe his attack on Cadiz?	☐	☐	☐	
59	What was the Babington Plot (1586)?	☐	☐	☐	
60	What was the 'Great Chain of Being'?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

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Date: _____

KT3.3: Exploration and voyages of discovery

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
61	What traditional English trade market collapsed, prompting the search for new global markets?	☐	☐	☐	
62	Name an essential navigational instrument that used the stars to determine latitude.	☐	☐	☐	
63	What type of new, highly manoeuvrable warship was developed by the English?	☐	☐	☐	
64	What term describes a sailor officially licensed by the Queen to attack Spanish ships?	☐	☐	☐	
65	Between which years did Francis Drake circumnavigate the globe?	☐	☐	☐	
66	What area of North America (modern-day California) did Drake claim for Elizabeth?	☐	☐	☐	
67	Roughly how much Spanish treasure did Drake bring back to England?	☐	☐	☐	
68	On which ship was Francis Drake knighted by Queen Elizabeth?	☐	☐	☐	
69	Which English nobleman was given a royal charter in 1584 to colonise North America?	☐	☐	☐	
70	What name was given to the new territory in honour of Elizabeth?	☐	☐	☐	
71	On which specific island off the coast of North America did the colonists land?	☐	☐	☐	
72	What was the name of the flagship that hit a sandbank, ruining the colony's food and seeds?	☐	☐	☐	
73	Name one of the aggressive military leaders of the 1585 expedition who caused conflict.	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
74	Which Native American Chief turned against the English and attacked the colony?	☐	☐	☐	
75	Why did Native Americans turn against the English settlers?	☐	☐	☐	
76	In what year was the second attempt to establish a colony (which included women and children) launched?	☐	☐	☐	
77	Who was the leader of the 1587 expedition who returned to England for supplies?	☐	☐	☐	
78	Why couldn't supply ships return to Virginia in 1588?	☐	☐	☐	
79	How long were the 1587 colonists left without any supplies or communication?	☐	☐	☐	
80	What is the famous nickname given to the 1587 settlement that vanished without a trace?	☐	☐	☐	

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Date: _____

KT3.3: Exploration and voyages of discovery

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
81	What was a 'vagrant' or 'vagabond'?	☐	☐	☐	
82	What were the 'deserving poor'?	☐	☐	☐	
83	What were the 'idle poor'?	☐	☐	☐	
84	What was the 1572 Vagabonds Act?	☐	☐	☐	
85	What caused poverty to rise in this period?	☐	☐	☐	
86	What was a typical subject studied at a Grammar school?	☐	☐	☐	
87	Were women allowed to act on stage?	☐	☐	☐	
88	What tactic did the English use to break the Spanish formation at Calais?	☐	☐	☐	
89	What was a 'privateer'?	☐	☐	☐	
90	What was the Act of Supremacy?	☐	☐	☐	
91	In what year did Queen Elizabeth grant Walter Raleigh a Royal Charter?	☐	☐	☐	
92	What traditional European English trade market had collapsed, encouraging New World expansion?	☐	☐	☐	
93	What name was given to the new territory in North America in honour of Elizabeth?	☐	☐	☐	
94	Did Walter Raleigh personally lead the expeditions to North America?	☐	☐	☐	
95	Name the two Native Americans brought to England in 1584 to help with translation.	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
96	Strategically, what did the English hope to use a colony in Virginia for?	☐	☐	☐	
97	On which specific island was the colony established?	☐	☐	☐	
98	Who was the aggressive military governor of the 1585 expedition?	☐	☐	☐	
99	Who was the brilliant mathematician and mapmaker on the 1585 expedition?	☐	☐	☐	
100	What was the name of the flagship that hit a sandbank, ruining the colony's food and seeds?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

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Date: _____

KT3.4: Raleigh and Virginia

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
101	Why were the 1585 colonists poorly suited to building a settlement?	☐	☐	☐	
102	Which Native American Chief turned against the English and was killed by Ralph Lane?	☐	☐	☐	
103	Apart from violence, what unwittingly killed many Native Americans?	☐	☐	☐	
104	Who rescued the surviving 1585 colonists and took them back to England?	☐	☐	☐	
105	How did the demographics of the 1587 expedition differ from the 1585 expedition?	☐	☐	☐	
106	Who was the leader of the 1587 expedition?	☐	☐	☐	
107	Why were the Native Americans immediately hostile to the 1587 colonists?	☐	☐	☐	
108	Why was John White unable to return to Virginia with supplies in 1588?	☐	☐	☐	
109	How long was John White stranded in England?	☐	☐	☐	
110	What single word was found carved into a post when White finally returned?	☐	☐	☐	
111	Why did English sailors explore the world?	☐	☐	☐	
112	What new technology helped Elizabethan exploration?	☐	☐	☐	
113	Who was the first Englishman to circumnavigate the globe (1577-1580)?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
114	Who did Elizabeth give a patent to colonize North America in 1584?	☐	☐	☐	
115	Why did the first Roanoke settlement (1585) fail?	☐	☐	☐	
116	What happened to the second Roanoke settlement (1587)?	☐	☐	☐	
117	What caused poverty to rise in the Elizabethan period?	☐	☐	☐	
118	What was the 1572 Vagabonds Act?	☐	☐	☐	
119	Who led the Spanish Armada?	☐	☐	☐	
120	What was the Ridolfi Plot (1571)?	☐	☐	☐	

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Date: _____

THE VAULT

Restricted Access: Answer Keys

KT3.1: Education and leisure

1. Humanism
2. Roger Ascham
3. The printing press
4. A Petty School / Dame School
5. A hornbook
6. A Grammar School
7. Latin
8. 30% of men, 10% of women
9. Real tennis / Hawking / Fencing / Hunting on horseback
10. Mob football
11. Bear-baiting and Bull-baiting
12. She loved it and frequently ordered private exhibitions
13. Religious mystery plays
14. Christopher Marlowe
15. 1576
16. Groundlings
17. The Puritans
18. The Vagabonds Act
19. The Lord Chamberlain's Men / The Earl of Leicester's Men
20. They attracted crime/prostitutes beyond the Mayor's control and spread the Bubonic Plague
21. The Duke of Medina Sidonia.
22. To sail to the Netherlands, pick up the Duke of Parma's army, and transport them to invade England.
23. They sent burning fireships into the Spanish fleet.
24. The Battle of Gravelines.
25. Strong winds (the 'Protestant Wind') blew the Spanish ships north around Scotland, destroying dozens on the rocks.
26. He attacked the Spanish fleet, destroying ships and supplies.
27. February 1587.
28. An alliance between England and Dutch Protestant rebels.
29. Elizabeth's spymaster.



30. The mandatory Protestant prayer book introduced in 1559.
31. It grew rapidly from roughly 3 million to over 4 million
32. Rapid inflation (prices rising much faster than wages)
33. Enclosure
34. The European wool trade was more lucrative and it required fewer workers to pay
35. They migrated to towns and cities looking for work, becoming vagrants/vagabonds
36. Antwerp
37. The Impotent Poor
38. The Able-bodied Poor
39. A vagabond or vagrant
40. They believed they spread disease, committed crimes, and could start a rebellion

KT3.2: The Problem of Poverty

41. Thomas Harman
42. A beggar who faked epileptic fits using soap to get sympathy money
43. Being whipped and having a hole burned through the right ear
44. Execution
45. The national Poor Rate
46. Justices of the Peace / JPs
47. That some able-bodied people wanted to work but simply couldn't find employment
48. Raw materials, like wool and hemp, to work with and sell
49. Houses of Correction
50. They realised the sheer scale of the crisis could lead to starvation and a massive peasant rebellion if left ignored
51. Petty schools (for young children) and Grammar schools (for older boys of the middling sorts).
52. Latin or Greek.
53. Bear-baiting or bull-baiting.
54. The Globe, The Theatre, or The Rose.
55. No, all female roles were played by young boys.
56. The Duke of Medina Sidonia.
57. The major battle where English ships heavily damaged the Armada.
58. 'Singeing the King of Spain's beard.'
59. The final plot that proved Mary's guilt via coded letters.
60. The Tudor belief in a strict, God-given social hierarchy.

KT3.3: Exploration and voyages of discovery

61. The Antwerp cloth market
62. The Astrolabe / Quadrant
63. The Galleon
64. Privateer
65. 1577–1580
66. Nova Albion
67. £400,000
68. The Golden Hind
69. Sir Walter Raleigh
70. Virginia
71. Roanoke Island

- 72. The Tiger
- 73. Ralph Lane (or Richard Grenville)
- 74. Chief Wingina
- 75. English demands for food, aggressive behaviour, and the spread of deadly European diseases
- 76. 1587
- 77. John White
- 78. All English ships were requisitioned to fight the Spanish Armada
- 79. Three years
- 80. The 'Lost Colony'

KT3.3: Exploration and voyages of discovery

81. A homeless person who wandered from place to place looking for work, heavily feared by the authorities.
82. Those who were too old, young, or ill to work and deserved help.
83. Those who were fit to work but couldn't find a job, often seen as lazy criminals.
84. A harsh law where vagabonds could be whipped and have a hole burned through their ear.
85. Population growth, bad harvests, and the enclosure of farming land for sheep.
86. Latin.
87. No, boys played female roles.
88. Fireships.
89. A state-licensed pirate.
90. The law that made Elizabeth Supreme Governor of the Church.
91. 1584
92. The Antwerp cloth market
93. Virginia
94. No, Elizabeth refused to let him leave court
95. Manteo and Wanchese
96. As a hidden base for privateers to attack Spanish treasure ships
97. Roanoke Island
98. Ralph Lane
99. Thomas Harriot
100. The Tiger

KT3.4: Raleigh and Virginia

101. They were mostly soldiers and gentlemen with no farming skills
102. Chief Wingina
103. European diseases to which they had no immunity
104. Francis Drake
105. It included families, women, and children with farming skills
106. John White
107. Because of the violence and murders committed by Ralph Lane's men in 1585
108. Elizabeth banned all ships from leaving England to fight the Spanish Armada
109. Three years / until 1590
110. CROATOAN
111. To expand trade, bypass Spanish monopolies, and find new trade routes.
112. Astrolabes for navigation, better maps, and more agile ships like galleons.



- 113. Sir Francis Drake.
- 114. Sir Walter Raleigh.
- 115. Due to food shortages and conflict with Native Americans.
- 116. It became the 'Lost Colony'; when a supply ship returned in 1590, everyone had vanished.
- 117. Population growth and bad harvests.
- 118. A law punishing vagrants with whipping and ear-burning.
- 119. The Duke of Medina Sidonia.
- 120. An assassination plot against Elizabeth backed by Spanish troops.

Mastery Tracker

Track your total recall score across all 120 questions.

Attempt	Date	Score (/120)	Parent/Guardian Signature	Target for Next Time
1				
2				
3				

Operative Reflection

My ultimate strength in this unit is...

The three specific facts I need to hunt down and memorize tonight are...